DOE ASPECT · DE-FOA-0003647 · TOPIC AREA 1, SUBTOPIC 1a

What is filed, and who signs

Concept paper stage first, then what falls at Stage 1. Each row is marked for whether it was confirmed on a DOE source read this run or is anticipated and still needs checking against the template.

CONFIRMED	Verified on a DOE source read on 2026-10-05 or 2026-09-25, cited in the row.	ANTICIPATED	Expected but not verified. NOFO Part 1 is a Word file this container cannot retrieve.	NOT APPLICABLE	Does not apply to this a nnouncement.

CONCEPT PAPER STAGE

Due 2026-10-09, 5:00 PM ET

CONFIRMED

Concept paper, five pages maximum

WHERE DOE eXCHANGE, announcement DE-FOA-0003647 | SIGNS No signature stated at this stage

Required, not optional. Must be limited to a single concept, technology, or project. Anything beyond page five is not reviewed and may result in disqualification. A NOFO-specific template is posted on eXCHANGE; all of the content in it is required, use of the template itself is not. Source: DOE's published webinar transcript for this NOFO.

CONFIRMED

DOE eXCHANGE account for PlastiBioFuel LLC

WHERE eere-exchange.energy.gov | SIGNS Michael Ward registers

Submission is through eXCHANGE only. DOE will not review or consider applications submitted through other means. The system returned from its consolidation outage on 2026-10-04 at 6:00 AM ET.

CONFIRMED

Active SAM.gov registration with UEI

WHERE sam.gov | SIGNS No action required

Active and confirmed. DOE restated the requirement in the webinar and warned that new registrations take several weeks. Not an open item for PlastiBioFuel.

ANTICIPATED

Concept paper content fields and cover information

WHERE The template posted on eXCHANGE | SIGNS Michael Ward completes

NOFO Part 1 section 4.C lists the required concept paper content. That document is published only as a Word file, and this container cannot retrieve it: files.simpler.grants.gov is refused by network policy and the eXCHANGE copy is served as a download. The field order in this package follows DOE's four published concept paper evaluation factors. Check it against the template before uploading.

ANTICIPATED

Generative AI use disclosure

WHERE Wherever the template asks | SIGNS Michael Ward attests

DOE asks applicants to state the extent of generative AI use and how it was used. Whether this NOFO's concept paper carries the question was not verified. Ready-to-use language is below, and it is correct whether the question appears at concept paper or at Stage 1.

NOT APPLICABLE

SF-424 family and other Grants.gov forms

WHERE Not filed | SIGNS No signature

Not applicable at this stage. This announcement is administered through DOE eXCHANGE, and Grants.gov is not an accepted route.

STAGE 1 STAGE

Due 2026-12-01, 5:00 PM ET

CONFIRMED

Letter or letters of commitment

WHERE Stage 1 application | SIGNS An industrial partner signs

Modification 000001 moved Letters of Commitment from Stage 2 to Stage 1 and added a clause in section III.D saying they are submitted with Stage 1 applications. They are not required with the concept paper. The NOFO separately treats an application with no industrial entity as applicant or partner as not of interest, and PlastiBioFuel satisfies that as prime by itself.

CONFIRMED

Technical volume within the page limit

WHERE Stage 1 application | SIGNS Michael Ward submits

Fifteen pages for Subtopic 1a, inclusive of cover page, table of contents, citations, charts, graphs, maps, photos, and all other graphics. Twenty-five for 1b, thirty for 2a, twenty-five for 2b.

ANTICIPATED

Cost share documentation, 20 percent minimum

WHERE Stage 1 application | SIGNS Michael Ward commits

Topic Area 1 carries a 20 percent minimum cost share. Stated here as a share of total project cost, which is the standard DOE basis: on a $2,000,000 federal share that is $500,000 against a $2,500,000 total project. Confirm the basis against the cost sharing section of NOFO Part 1 before Stage 1.

ANTICIPATED

Research, Technology and Economic Security review materials

WHERE Stage 1 application | SIGNS Michael Ward submits

DOE stated that Stage 1 includes the core documents needed for a technical review and for the RTES review. The specific RTES forms were not verified.

READY-TO-USE GENERATIVE AI DISCLOSURE

Generative artificial intelligence was used to draft the narrative text of this concept paper from named source documents, and is disclosed here for that use. It generated no experimental value and no citation. Every laboratory number in this concept paper traces to the University of North Texas Final Project Report for Phase I signed by Prof. Shengqian Ma and dated 2026-08-07, and every reference was checked against PubMed by identifier.

Separately, and not as a writing aid, simulation and modeling software is part of the subject matter of the work. The spiral-flow reactor geometry referenced in this concept paper was derived computationally by Michael David Ward. That modeling is the company's own technical program, it is described as such, and it is not a drafting tool.

PlastiBioFuel LLC is responsible for the accuracy, authenticity, and authorship of this submission, is fully capable of performing the work described, and represents that the submission does not infringe the rights of any third party.

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